

mental energy, etc. Values-based spending is how we decide to steward our limited resources to make sure we're getting the most out of them. We are whole people, and money isn't always the most important thing to us at any given time. But with values-based spending, managing money well is a smaller part of a bigger overarching purpose.

When you take action on what you've learned in this book, you are giving yourself permission to make changes in your finances and beyond. When you live and spend in alignment with what you love, you also let the people around you know that they too can buy what they love. You lead your children by example, you encourage your partner to pursue their values, you give friends and coworkers permission to say yes and no, and you help your family break generational biases about money.

You vote with your money, not just by punching a ballot card in a rec center once a year, but every day with every dollar. And you find value not just in what values-based spending can do for you but how it serves you. You know that every spending choice you make has an impact, whether immediate or eternal.

Contrary to popular belief, our brains are not "hardwired" to keep consuming more and more. Yes, our culture values what you have and how you look—this book is not going to change that—but you can change. Seriously, the brain has an incredible amount of plasticity. You can retrain your brain at any age.

You won't be one to get inspired quickly but fall off because of the surprises life inevitably brings. You can change your life, the lives of people around you, and of those you'll never meet with whatever income you have. But it doesn't happen overnight. It takes time to afford the dream vacation, pay off debt, improve your salary, and invest for retirement. And that's OK, that's how it's supposed to be! Reality is boring and steady and won't go the way we expect it to. If you get to know people who are consistently achieving their goals, you'll start to realize that there's nothing special about them that uniquely positions them to succeed. It's their commitment to the process. They value why they're working toward something as much as what they get from doing it. They eventually fall in love with the daily practice as much as, if not more than, the destination. In fact, when you focus so intensely on the destination, you miss opportunities throughout the process to achieve successes you didn't know were possible. We chase